Grace Schweitzer

From: Steven M. Schultz <sschultz@Princeton.EDU>
Sent: Friday, December 13, 2019 5:57 PM
To: Jack West; Vivian S.; frank ryle; karla cook
Cc: Liz Lempert; Sophie Glovier; Marc Dashield; Deanna Stockton
Subject: Re: 86 Spruce St. apt building rear - potential flooding hazard

Hello Jack,

I wanted to send a belated thank you for your work on this paving issue. I very much appreciate your care in talking with us about it and your diligence in overseeing these adjustments. I've now had the chance to observe a couple substantial rains, and it looks like the measures are working as planned. So given that we had no choice in adding all that asphalt, I think you brought us to the best outcome under those circumstances.

Thanks also to Sophie for coming right over on the weekend after we discovered what was being done.

Thanks again,
Steven

From: Jack West <jwest@princetonnj.gov>
Date: Tuesday, November 19, 2019 at 7:01 AM
To: Steven Schultz <sschultz@Princeton.EDU>, Vivian Slee [Personal Email Add]@googlemail.com>, frank ryle <frank.ryle@gmail.com>, Karla Cook [Personal Email Add]@mac.com>
Cc: Liz Lempert <llempert@princetonnj.gov>, Sophie Glovier <[Personal Email Add]@gmail.com>, Marc Dashield <mdashield@princetonnj.gov>, Deanna Stockton <dstockton@princetonnj.gov>
Subject: RE: 86 Spruce St. apt building rear - potential flooding hazard

Steven
I met with the developer yesterday and he has agreed to make all the corrections outlined in your email
give me a call if you have any questions
Jack

From: Steven M. Schultz [mailto:sschultz@Princeton.EDU]
Sent: Monday, November 18, 2019 1:07 PM
To: Jack West; Vivian S.; frank ryle; karla cook
Cc: Liz Lempert; Sophie Glovier; Marc Dashield; Deanna Stockton
Subject: Re: 86 Spruce St. apt building rear - potential flooding hazard

Hi Jack,

Thank you very much for your time meeting this morning at our property and the Hamilton park area. It was a helpful conversation.

I wanted to recap some of the points we discussed – please add or correct if I have anything wrong, particularly the bolded items:

- As you mentioned in the email below, the town regs already consider the surface to be impermeable so a change to asphalt is allowed. Nonetheless you asked the developer for storm-water management measures.

- I noted that despite the regulatory definition, the gravel has been functioning as a permeable surface because there currently is not a problem with runoff, as evidenced by the lack of any sign of erosion or silt buildup at the bottom of the hill. Asphalt will certainly behave differently, increasing the volume of runoff and the speed of the flow.
- We observed the storm-water management efforts that the developer has started.
    - You acknowledged that the current sluice from the low-point of the parking lot to the "rainwater garden" is inadequate. As currently executed, the design appears that it would do little to stop and redirect the flow (a 90-degree turn) to the pond.
    - I believe you stated that **you will require the developer to dig out the channel** by another 10 or 12 inches. I would submit that it should probably be lined with heavy gravel.
- We discussed the possibility of water flowing off the west side of the lot, because the overall flow of the parking lot is from south to north and from east to west
    - The primary protection to stop water from going off the west edge of the lot onto our property is the mulch around the arborvitae plantings. I suggested this seems inadequate.
    - I believe **you agreed to ask the developer to pitch the asphalt** on the west edge of the lot back toward the center of the lot. That would entail the strip of land under the row of cars at that edge, so that, as you said, the water would flow from the fronts of the cars to the backs. This would result in a slight crease in the parking lot, in line with the sluice that leads to the pond.
- We discussed what assurances are in place to make sure the storm-water management performs as planned.
    - You stated that the developer has posted a bond with the town and is under a two-year maintenance agreement, so that if problems occur with the flow **you can and will require modifications to rectify any problems**.
- I observed that possibility that some of the current surface water from the gravel lot ends up at the low point of our yard where I have wetland plantings and a small pond. I noted that this run-off, if it is occurring, is an acceptable feature of the topography. I stated my position that once the parking lot is paved, **I don't want *any* of the runoff from asphalt to reach our property** because of the petroleum, rubber, salts, and other vehicular residue that is always a part of runoff from pavement. Again, the volume and speed of flow will be vastly increased so none of the normal washing and cleaning of the runoff will occur and all the contaminants will come with the flow. Thus all our trust needs to go into the engineered solution (the retention pond and drain) and not the natural solution of percolation.

Does this all sound correct to you?

Thank you again.

Steven

From: Jack West <jwest@princetonnj.gov>
Date: Monday, November 18, 2019 at 8:58 AM
To: Steven Schultz <sschultz@Princeton.EDU>, Vivian Slee <[Personal Email Add redacted]@googlemail.com>, frank ryle <frank.ryle@gmail.com>, Karla Cook <[Personal redacted]@mac.com>
Cc: Liz Lempert <llempert@princetonnj.gov>, Sophie Glovier <[Personal Email Add redacted]@gmail.com>, Marc Dashield <mdashield@princetonnj.gov>, Deanna Stockton <dstockton@princetonnj.gov>
Subject: RE: 86 Spruce St. apt building rear - potential flooding hazard

Steven
I can meet you any time this morning
Jack

From: Steven M. Schultz [mailto:sschultz@Princeton.EDU]
Sent: Monday, November 18, 2019 8:56 AM
To: Jack West; Vivian S.; frank ryle; karla cook
Cc: Liz Lempert; Sophie Glovier; Marc Dashield; Deanna Stockton
Subject: Re: 86 Spruce St. apt building rear - potential flooding hazard

Hello Jack,

Thank you for your quick response. I am the immediate neighbor at 82 Spruce Street and also am very concerned anbout this project. Could you please meet me at the property at some point this morning or after 2:30?

I am not a water expert but have watched this property for the 15 years my wife and I have lived here. I think it is a mistake to consider the existing lot to be impermeable. I have never observed running water on that surface even in the most torrential rains. There are no signs of erosion that you would expect to see at the bottom of the lot if water were running in streams from that lot. It is very hard for me to imagine asphalt behaving in the same way as gravel over such a vast area. By my calculation, more than 70% of the lot will be covered by impermeable surface.

I would like you to please show us how the proposed rain garden would work. It does not currently appear to be at the low point of the parking lot. The low point appears to be in the north-westerly direction, which is the side facing my property. The rain garden is on the north-easterly side.

My wife and I have put years into restoring the lower part of our property to an organic native plant garden. That work appears to be very much in jeopardy from an onslaught on asphalt runoff.

It would be very helpful to meet in person and go over these plans. My cell number is Personal Info

Thank you.
Steven

From: Jack West <jwest@princetonnj.gov>
Date: Monday, November 18, 2019 at 8:38 AM
To: Vivian Slee <Personal Email Add@googlemail.com>, frank ryle <frank.ryle@gmail.com>, Karla Cook <Personal @mac.com>, Steven Schultz <sschultz@Princeton.EDU>
Cc: Liz Lempert <llempert@princetonnj.gov>, Sophie Glovier <Personal Email @gmail.com>, Marc Dashield <mdashield@princetonnj.gov>, Deanna Stockton <dstockton@princetonnj.gov>
Subject: RE: 86 Spruce St. apt building rear - potential flooding hazard

Vivian
As you are aware there has always been a large gravel parking lot at 86 Spruce, with no stormwater management, the Princeton stormwater ordinance considers gravel to be 100% impervious, and therefore the developer is allowed to pave. To be conservative we required the developer to installed a rain garden with an overflow that ties into the municipal system.
I hope this addresses your concerns, please feel free to contact me with any additional questions.

Jack West, P.E.
400 Witherspoon Street
Princeton, NJ 08540
609-921-7077

From: Vivian S. [mailto:[redacted]@googlemail.com]
Sent: Sunday, November 17, 2019 11:01 AM
To: Jack West; frank ryle; karla cook; Steven M. Schultz
Subject: 86 Spruce St. apt building rear - potential flooding hazard

Dear Mr. West,

I am writing as we live at 80 Spruce St. and our property extends from Spruce St. to Wiggins, and we are concerned about potential flooding at the rear of our property due to the impending paving of the parking lot at 86 Spruce St..

We are worried that the storm basins they've created just below the parking lot at 86 Spruce St. as well as for the newly redeveloped property at 88 Spruce St. may not be enough to manage water during and after big storms.

We'd be very grateful for your attention to this matter and thank you in advance.

Regards,

Vivian & Frank Ryle

vivian slee
slee.vivian@gmail.com
609 751 8924

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